



General Assembly

Substitute Bill No. 5475

February Session, 2026



***AN ACT CONCERNING OVERSIGHT OF PERMITTING PROCESSES
OF THE DEPARTMENT OF ENERGY AND ENVIRONMENTAL
PROTECTION.***

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Assembly convened:

1 Section 1. (*Effective from passage*) (a) Not later than January 1, 2027, the
2 Commissioner of Energy and Environmental Protection shall assess and
3 report on potential methods to facilitate the permitting process of
4 general permits, including (1) the use of artificial intelligence tools to do
5 the preliminary review of all applications, and (2) the feasibility of
6 creating an expedited review process with increased fees for the
7 expedited service for certain permits and identifying any permits
8 appropriate for such service and any statutory changes required to
9 effectuate such expedited review process.

10 (b) Not later than January 1, 2027, the Commissioner of Energy and
11 Environmental Protection shall assess and report on methods to
12 facilitate the permitting process of individual permits, including, but not
13 limited to, (1) permits for solid waste, thermal loop and fuel cell power
14 generation and coastal land management, whether there are increased
15 automation tools that businesses and municipalities could use to reform
16 the timeline and costs of permitting, and (2) the feasibility of creating an
17 expedited review process with increased fees for the expedited service
18 for certain permits and identifying any permits appropriate for such

19 service and any statutory changes required to effectuate such expedited
20 review process.

21 (c) Not later than January 1, 2027, the Commissioner of Energy and
22 Environmental Protection shall assess and report on the feasibility of
23 automating and reducing fees for the renewal of permits where the
24 applicant does not have any changes to the information given for the
25 original permit or the factors concerning permit renewal.

26 (d) Not later than January 1, 2027, the Commissioner of Energy and
27 Environmental Protection shall submit a report, in accordance with the
28 provisions of section 11-4a of the general statutes, to the joint standing
29 committees of the General Assembly having cognizance of matters
30 relating to the environment and government oversight. Such report
31 shall include the results of the commissioner's assessments pursuant to
32 subsections (a) to (c), inclusive, of this section and any recommendations
33 for legislation.

This act shall take effect as follows and shall amend the following sections:		
Section 1	<i>from passage</i>	New section

Statement of Legislative Commissioners:

In Subsec. (b)(1), "permits" and "power generation" were moved for clarity.

GOS *Joint Favorable Subst. C/R* **ENV**